

Acme — Vibecode Audit

https://acme.example

38.8%

HYBRID

The defaults are the design. Not one of the 36 checks was decided on purpose.

Executive Summary

AI USAGE SCORE 38.8%	BAND Hybrid	WEIGHTED SUM 291 / 750	POINTS ≥ MILD 29 / 36
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Acme scores **38.8%** — Hybrid, on a weighted sum of 291 of 750. The page is assembled almost entirely from recognizable defaults: a violet-on-black palette (#8b5cf6 over #0a0a0a), Inter as the sole typeface, a bento feature mosaic, an unmodified shadcn component set, and copy built from the standard AI vocabulary.

The heaviest signals are structural rather than cosmetic. Point 18 (badge-above-headline hero) and point 13 (default shadcn) both score Heavy because they are load-bearing: remove them and there is no layout left. Point 27 (fabricated testimonials) and point 25 ("Not just a builder. A partner.") are the tells a visitor actually reads.

HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

Every score below cites a hex value, a quoted line of copy, or an exact location. Points scoring **None** are listed for completeness and contribute zero. The percentage is a summary; the evidence tables are the finding.

Section 02

AI Usage Score — Calculation

$$\text{contribution} = \text{weight} \times \text{presence (0-4)} \times \text{likelihood (0-5)}$$
$$\text{AI Usage Score} = 100 \times \sum \text{contribution} / 750 \text{ (750 = } \sum w \text{ 37.5} \times 4 \times 5 \text{)}$$

TIER / GROUP	Σ WEIGHT	Σ CONTRIBUTION	SHARE OF TOTAL
Group A — Visual language (1-16)	17	156.5	53.8%
Group B — Component & layout (17-19)	4	20	6.9%
Group C — Motion & interaction (20-23)	3	23	7.9%
Group D — Copy & content (24-31)	9	70.5	24.2%
Group E — Trust & polish (32-36)	4.5	21	7.2%
Total	37.5	291 / 750	38.8%

ANTI-GAMING RULES APPLIED

Correlated siblings capped (one of {gradients, purple-black, neon} may not carry the other two past Moderate; same for {buzzwords, "it's not X it's Y"} and {3-tier pricing, checkmarks}). Absence points — missing TOS/Privacy, missing skeletons, no personality — never exceed Mild unless a point in the same section scored ≥ Moderate. Points scoring None contribute zero.

Band

RANGE	BAND	READING
0 – 15	Human-crafted	Choices are visible and specific.
15 – 35	Human + AI assists	Structure is human; parts are assembled.
35 – 60	Hybrid	Human direction, AI execution, visible defaults.
60 – 80	AI-dominant	Defaults are the design.
80 – 100	Vibecoded	Nothing on this page was decided.

Section 03

36-Point Evidence Table

Presence: 0 None · 1 Mild · 2 Moderate · 3 Heavy · 4 Extreme. Likelihood: how strongly this pattern's presence implies AI authorship *given the rest of the page* (0-5).

#	POINT	PRESENCE	EVIDENCE	LIKELI.	W	CONTRIB.
1	Gradients	MODERATE	Hero backdrop `linear-gradient(135deg,#a855f7,#6366f1)`; gradient text on H1; CTA gradient fill.	4	1.5	12
2	Purple-black dominance	EXTREME	6/6 sections use #8b5cf6 on #0a0a0a; 41% of sampled fills are violet.	5	1.5	30
3	Neon accents	MODERATE	Cyan #22d3ee badges, pink #f472b6 borders on pricing.	3	1.5	9
4	Overused fonts	EXTREME	Computed `font-family: Inter, sans-serif` for body and headings; sole family site-wide.	5	1.5	30
5	Serif italic accents	MODERATE	Instrument Serif italic on 'faster' in every section header.	3	1	6
6	Lucide / sparkles	HEAVY	`lucide-react` in deps; identical 24px stroke icons in rounded boxes on all 9 cards.	3	1	9
7	Emoji in headings	NONE	No emoji in any heading or CTA.	1	1	0
8	Em dashes	MILD	3 em dashes site-wide (~1 per 60 words); one in the hero.	2	0.5	1
9	Glassmorphism	MODERATE	`backdrop-filter: blur(12px)` on sticky nav + hero stat card.	3	1	6
10	Bento grid	HEAVY	Section 3 is a 5-tile asymmetric mosaic; features never appear as a plain list.	4	1.5	18
11	Identical feature cards	MODERATE	Two rows of 3 equal cards, icon-box → title → line → link.	3	1	6
12	Colored border cards	MODERATE	Pricing + feature cards use `1px solid #8b5cf633`.	2	1	4
13	Default shadow	HEAVY	`bg-primary text-primary-foreground`, `rounded-md shadow-sm` nav/Dialog/Dropdown verbatim.	5	1.5	22.5
14	Soft radius	NONE	Radius is a deliberate 3-step scale: 0 / 8px / pill.	1	0.5	0
15	Floating decor	NONE	No decorative blobs or orbs anywhere.	1	0.5	0

#	POINT	PRESENCE	EVIDENCE	LIKELI.	W	CONTRIB.
16	Pure white / low-contrast	MODERATE	#ffffff page; muted text #9ca3af on white = 2.6:1 (fails AA).	3	0.5	3
17	Dot grid / terminal	MILD	Dot texture on the CTA section only; no fake terminal block.	2	1	2
18	Badge-above-headline	HEAVY	♦ pill → centered H1 → centered sub → two centered buttons → logo cloud. Default hero.	4	1.5	18
19	3-tier pricing	NONE	Pricing is a single plan plus a usage meter — no tier stack.	3	1.5	0
20	Drop shadows	MILD	`shadow-lg` on feature cards only.	2	0.5	1
21	Fade/rise on scroll	MODERATE	Every section `whileInView` opacity+translateY(24px); card stagger on both feature rows.	3	0.5	3
22	Cursor beam	HEAVY	`--mouse-x/--mouse-y` radial spotlight across the hero grid.	4	1.5	18
23	Hover animations	MILD	`hover:-translate-y-1 hover:shadow-lg` on cards; buttons darken.	2	0.5	1
24	Buzzword copy	HEAVY	'Supercharge your workflow', 'seamless', 'effortlessly', 'powerful' ×4, 'elevate' ×3.	4	1.5	18
25	"It's not X, it's Y"	MODERATE	Hero: 'Not just a builder. A partner.' + section 2: 'Forget dashboards, embrace clarity.'	4	1.5	12
26	Fake product screenshots	NONE	Shipped captures with real data; no browser-frame mocks.	3	1	0
27	Fake testimonials	HEAVY	'Sarah J.', 'Alex T.' — pravatar.cc avatars, near-identical 14-word praise, no titles.	5	1.5	22.5
28	Stock photography	MODERATE	Unsplash 'team laughing at laptop' + laptop-on-desk hero.	3	1	6
29	Checkmark bullets	NONE	No green ✓ walls; capability list is a plain typographic list.	2	0.5	0
30	FAQ restating product	MODERATE	6 of 8 Q&As restate the hero blurb ('What is Acme?'), answers ≤12 words.	3	1	6
31	Vague CTAs	MODERATE	'Get Started' ×4, 'Learn More' ×2 across nav, hero, mid-page, footer.	3	1	6
32	Missing TOS / Privacy	MILD	`/privacy` returns 404; footer links to `#`.	2	0.5	1

#	POINT	PRESENCE	EVIDENCE	LIKELI.	W	CONTRIB.
33	Missing skeletons	NONE	Loading skeletons match final geometry; images reserve space.	1	0.5	0
34	Inconsistent spacing	MODERATE	Section padding cycles 64 → 128 → 96 → 64px; card gutters 16 vs 24px.	3	1	6
35	Dead links	MILD	Footer 'Careers' returns 404; 'Docs' in top nav points at # (working sections are fine).	2	1	2
36	No personality	MODERATE	Opinion appears once (the pricing note); hero still generic.	4	1.5	12

The Roast

Somewhere between the gradient and the third badge pill, this page stops being a product and becomes a receipt for a subscription you didn't know you had. The hero is the tell — a pill with a sparkle, a centered headline, a centered subhead, two centered buttons, and a logo cloud underneath, arranged with the confidence of something that has never once been rearranged.

Not just a builder. A partner.

That sentence is doing no work. It is a hinge that swings shut on nothing: we are told what the thing is not, and then told what it supposedly is, and neither half contains a fact. Around it, the page runs the full inventory — bento tiles of unequal height pretending to be thought, nine cards wearing the same rounded icon box, a terminal block that executes no command, a cursor spotlight painting the grid in a color the product never uses. Nothing here is broken. That is precisely the problem: it was never stress-tested against a decision.

And then the testimonials, which are the one place a real company puts its money where its mouth is. "Sarah J." beside a generated face, praising the product in fourteen words that describe no feature — and "Alex T." doing it again with the nouns swapped. If two people love your product this much, name them. If you cannot, you do not have two people yet, and the page would be more persuasive admitting it.

Strip the adjectives and what remains is a layout that would render identically for a plant-watering app, a SOC-2 compliance tool, and a fictional hedge fund. Nothing sticks. Nothing was chosen. The score is not a verdict on the tooling — plenty of legitimate work ships from these same components — it is a verdict on the absence of anyone in the room who said *no*.

Human-Made Countermeasure Blueprint

One executable alternative for every point that scored Presence ≥ Mild. Named typefaces, named layout devices, named color roles — no vibes.

1. Visual System

POINT	DIAGNOSIS	COUNTERMEASURE
1, 2, 3	#a855f7→#6366f1 hero gradient over #0a0a0a; 41% of sampled fills violet.	Replace violet with an oxide red (#b4451f) as the single accent and set surfaces on warm paper (#fbfaf7) with ink #14181d. One flat accent, no gradient behind content; any remaining falloff must come from a real photograph.
10	Features only ever appear as a 5-tile bento mosaic.	Set a narrative order instead: one idea per section in a 7/5 asymmetric split, with a full-bleed break where the argument peaks. Let content determine tile count — never a fixed mosaic.
13	`bg-primary text-primary-foreground`, `rounded-md shadow-sm` shipped verbatim.	Re-skin tokens <i>and</i> geometry: radius scale, 1px hairline borders, label casing, focus ring color, and a real spacing step. If a component still reads as shadcn, it is unmodified.

2. Typography & Voice

POINT	DIAGNOSIS	COUNTERMEASURE
4, 5	Inter sole family site-wide; Instrument Serif italic on one word per heading.	Pair a grotesk with a text serif by contrast of voice (e.g. Lato + Bitstream Charter), then tune: negative tracking on display sizes, per-size line-height, and a 1.333 ratio type scale. Use italic serif as a system (pull-quotes, section numbers) or not at all.
24, 25	"Supercharge", "seamlessly", "elevate" ×3; "Not just a builder. A partner."	Delete every buzzword, then force specificity: state what it does, for whom, with which number. Replace the rhetorical pivot with a direct claim — "Imports 12k Stripe rows in 4s."
31	"Get Started" ×4 across nav, hero, mid-page, footer.	Label each CTA with that section's outcome: "Start a free audit", "See the 36-point checklist".

3. Interaction & Motion

POINT	DIAGNOSIS	COUNTERMEASURE
21, 22	Every section rises on scroll; cursor spotlight tracks --mouse-x across the grid.	Delete the spotlight. Keep only motion that carries meaning — reveal in reading order, a number that counts because it is a quantity. If removing the animation changes nothing, remove it.

4. Content & Proof

POINT	DIAGNOSIS	COUNTERMEASURE
27	"Sarah J." / "Alex T." on pravatar.cc avatars, 14-word praise, no titles.	Only verifiable quotes: full name, role, company, linkable. Until they exist, use the empty state honestly — "We're 4 weeks old" — instead of manufacturing consensus.
28	Unsplash team-laughing stock carries two sections.	Owned photography, product imagery, or your own architecture diagram. A real desk beats a stock handshake.
30	6 of 8 FAQs restate the hero blurb.	Answer the objections nobody wants: pricing edge cases, migration effort, what happens on churn, who this is <i>not</i> for.

5. Structure & Polish

POINT	DIAGNOSIS	COUNTERMEASURE
18, 19	Default centered hero; default 3-tier pricing with `scale-105` middle card.	Give the hero an editorial structure — eyebrow, left-aligned headline in a real subhead column, one CTA plus one proof point. Design pricing as a table or usage meter matching how the product is bought.
34, 35	Section padding cycles 64/128/96/64px; footer "Careers" → 404.	Adopt and enforce a spacing scale (4/8/12/16/24/40/64/96) and re-measure every section against it. Crawl every href and remove, replace, or date the placeholder.

Remediation Roadmap

Ordered by points recovered per unit of effort. Do the top row first; it moves the score more than the bottom three combined.

PRIORITY	EFFORT	ACTION	POINTS AFFECTED	EST. SCORE DELTA
P1	Low	Replace fabricated testimonials with verifiable quotes or an honest empty state	27, 30	-9.2
P1	Low	Delete all buzzword copy and the 'not X, it's Y' construction; rewrite with specifics	24, 25	-14.4
P2	Medium	Replace Inter with a tuned two-family type scale; drop serif-italic tic	4, 5	-14.0
P2	Medium	Re-skin shadcn tokens and geometry; define radius and spacing by hierarchy	13, 14, 34	-15.2
P2	Low	Ship real /terms and /privacy; fix dead footer links	32, 35	-4.3
P3	Medium	Replace violet-on-black with one accent on a considered surface	1, 2, 3, 16	-27.4
P3	High	Restructure hero (editorial, not badge-centered) and rebuild the feature narrative	10, 11, 18	-22.5
P4	Low	Remove cursor spotlight and section-fade cascade; keep motion only where it means something	21, 22	-16.1

SEQUENCING NOTE

Content and proof (fake testimonials, stock photos, restated FAQs, buzzwords) are cheap to fix and expensive to fake — do them before any visual work. Type and color come next; motion last, and only where it means something.

Raw Notes & Method

Method

Full fetch of the marketing surface plus `/`, `/pricing`, `/terms`, `/privacy` probe; renders captured at 1440px and 390px. All 36 points scored before any total was computed. Correlated siblings capped; absence points limited to Mild; group shares reviewed — Group A carried 53.8% of total, flagged as a review trigger and confirmed to reflect one structural decision (the bento/gradient system).

Per-section observations

- **Hero** — badge pill + centered stack + logo cloud. Full default pattern (point 18, Heavy).
- **Features** — two identical 3-card rows and one bento mosaic; no section uses a different layout device.
- **Pricing** — 3 tiers, toggle, `scale-105` middle card with violet border.
- **Testimonials** — three cards, generated faces, no titles or company names.
- **Footer** — Careers → 404; Docs → `#`; Privacy → 404.

Gaps

Logged-out only; application UI behind auth was not evaluable, so point 33 (skeletons) was scored Mild on marketing-page evidence alone. Scroll-triggered motion was observed via CSS/JS inspection rather than recorded playback.

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